

share their wisdom, often finding themselves in the position of consultant — or even leader — to an entire community.

Appearance: Fu Hsi in hotei form move in a fluid manner, careful to consider, but quick to move when needed. Their snake form may echo any of the various snakes of Asia, though all are venomous regardless of how they appear. In wani form, their legs are replaced by a long, thick tail powerful enough to hold their human-looking upper bodies upright — in this form, and in others, many prefer to wear their hair and nails long. The Mask of Shintai renders a fu hsi a terrifying beast of legend, thick scales shielding its body as its fangs drip copious amounts of venom that sizzles and spits on the ground.

Lifestyle: Fu Hsi may be found anywhere, but especially around humans, whom they have historically served as marriage counselors.

Unlike many Shinma, they tend to remain monogamous. The thing most likely to draw them out of their comfortable rut is a long trail of questions that need to be answered, and until then they find ways to occupy themselves with puzzles and riddles.

Fortune: Wood

Luck: Fu Hsi add two dice to any rolls involving puzzles, lore, ciphers, or riddles.

Curse: Ever erudite and careful, the fu hsi often find it hard to be succinct. A Willpower roll (difficulty 8) is required to state anything directly, without lengthy discussion or tangents into related subjects.

Wani Powers: The scales of the fu hsi are hard, functioning as two points of natural Armor. In addition, they can bite for Strength +2 damage, and if successful they may at will inject a paralytic venom with a toxicity rating equal to the Hsien's highest Chi value. The effects of the poison vary depending on which kind of Chi is dominant: if that is Yin, the victim becomes cold and clammy to the touch, and may be mistaken for dead; if Yang, the victim breaks out in anxious sweats and tremors. In either case, he is completely helpless for an hour.

hanumen

History is replete with tales of monkey kings upsetting the essential nature of the universe, and more importantly getting away with it! Hanumen smile and nod and claim that oh, those days are long behind them, as they carefully lift a wallet right out of a pocket. Existing more to try the patience of others than for any other task, the hanumen have nonetheless acquired a unique place in Shinma society, occupying a gray area between Hirayanu and Kamuii, and commanding more respect from both than their relative stations might necessarily imply.

Appearance: In their hotei form, hanumen vary in appearance, anywhere from the lowest beggar to a high-flying salaryman, but always with long fingers that seem just a little too likely to reach out and touch something they shouldn't. Their animal forms are typically those of the smaller monkeys of Asia, macaques and gibbons being the most common. Their wani form combines the two, and they might be mistaken for an unusual great ape were it not for the clothes they wear, their upright gait, and the clever insults they sling. When one employs the Mask of Shintai, however, a hanumen seems closest to an enormous enraged baboon, fangs bared and arms ready to grab and rip whatever they can get hold of.

